LESSON 10

Für Elise

Beethoven wrote it in 1810 for a mystery Elise: the most famous piano piece in the world.

IN THIS SONG **the A position** **D♯ and G♯** **3/4: three beats a bar** **rests**

LISTEN FIRST

Scan the code: listen to the whole song once, then hum along the second time.

1 Meet the song

Listen, pointing to each note. No words this time: hum it. Then play it, hands apart, then together.



THE WOW MOMENT

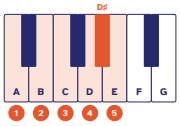
☆ **The most famous piano piece in the world.** Play the first line to anyone, anywhere: they will know it. Passport: Beethoven, your second stamp from him.

☐ **Listened and pointed** ☐ **Hummed the famous line** ☐ **Played it with both hands**

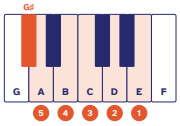
2 Take it apart

The same song, one piece at a time: first its rhythm, then its notes.

RIGHT HAND · A POSITION



LEFT HAND · AN OCTAVE LOWER



NEW IN THIS SONG

The A position: both hands on A. **D♯** is D's best friend, the black key to its right; the right thumb dips to **G♯**. **3/4:** three beats a bar.

THE RHYTHM

Count ONE two three. Clap on the coral numbers, hold through the grey, open your hands on a rest.

THE TIME

$\frac{3}{4}$

Top 3: three beats in every bar: ONE two three.
Bottom 4: a crotchet is one beat.

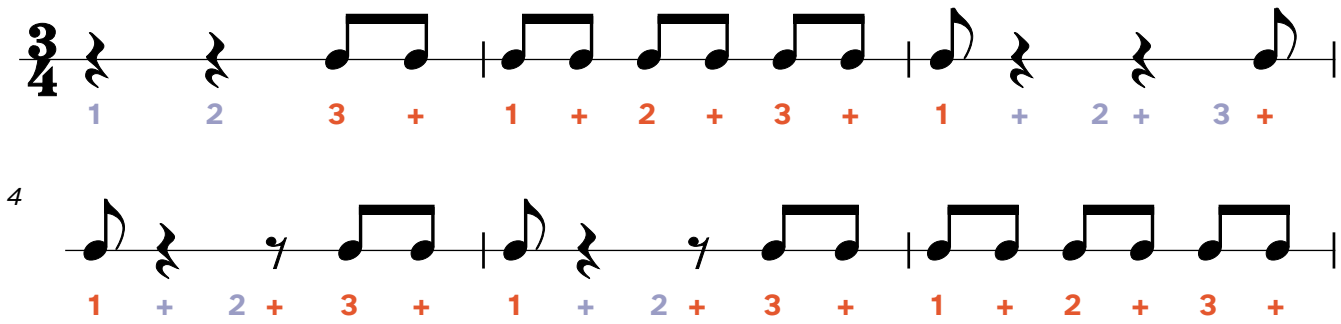
THE NOTES

two quavers: run-ning
1 beat

crotchet: walk
1 beat

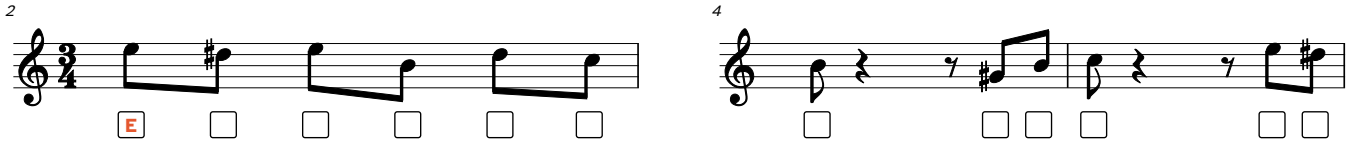
crotchet rest: wait
1 beat

dotted minim: hold-2-3
3 beats



THE NOTES

Write the letter under each note of the famous line; D♯ is D with its sharp.



SPOT THE MISTAKE Your teacher plays D instead of D♯. Put up your hand: the spooky colour is gone. Then the other way: G instead of G♯.

- [ ] **Counted in three**
- [ ] **Clapped it**
- [ ] **Wrote the letters**
- [ ] **Spotted the mistake**

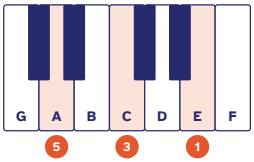
3 Your first lead sheet

A lead sheet: the tune on top, only chord names below. Play the roots from the names.

MEET THE ROOTS

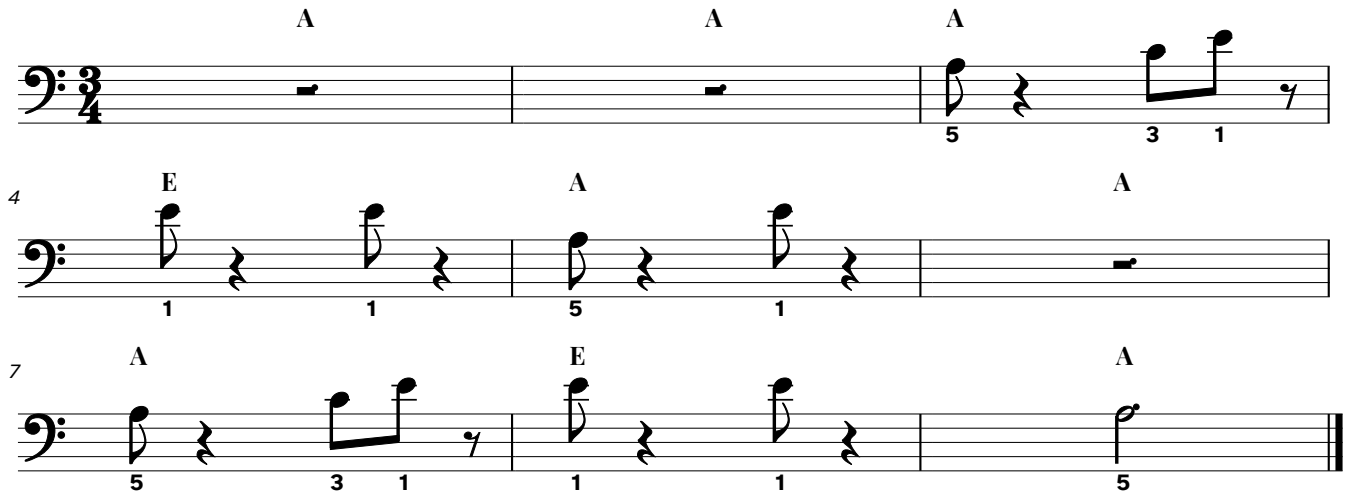
Two roots: A (left hand 5) and E (left thumb). Am is A minor, the sad A chord; E pulls back to A.

LEFT HAND · A POSITION, 5 ON A



THE LEFT HAND ON ITS OWN

Its part, with the names above: A for Am, E for E, and the C E that climbs in the gaps.



PLAY FROM THE NAMES

Only the names now. Hold each bar's root (A or E) while your teacher or the band plays the tune.

Am	Am	E	Am	Am	Am	E	Am

4 · CHECK

☐ I can count in three ☐ I can find D♯ and G♯ ☐ I can play the famous line

I can play it: colour a step each time you climb

	Slowly	Steady	With the band	Fast
From the notes				
From the names				

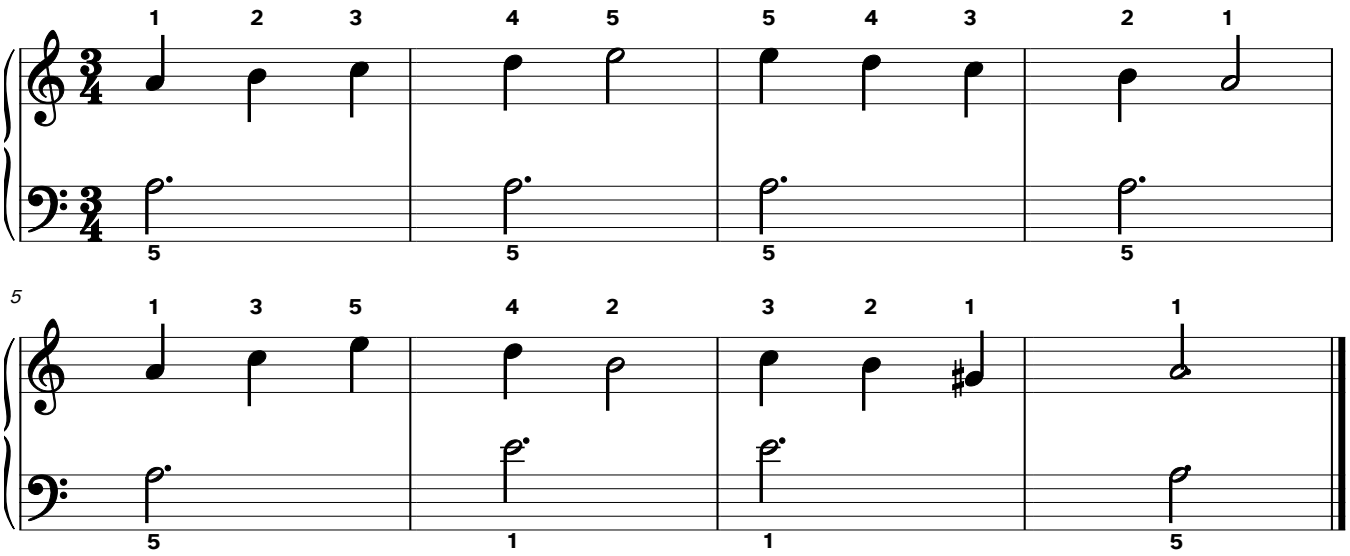
TEACHER ☐ Pass ☐ Not yet

+ More to play

Two more in three-time: a ghost walk in the A position, and a waltz back home in C.

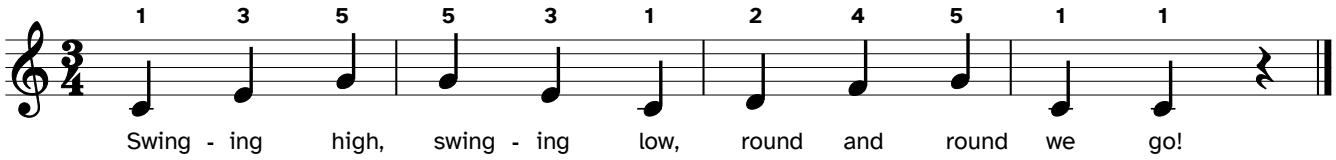
GHOST WALK

The A position, hands together: the right hand walks the five keys while the left hand holds its root. Spooky, soft, smooth.



SWING SONG

A waltz for the C position: three beats in a bar, lean on ONE, like a swing.



MAKE IT YOURS

Pick one and play the whole piece that way. Can your teacher guess which?

- ☐ **Ghostly: very soft, the D♯ a whisper**
- ☐ **From the names: your teacher plays the tune, you play the roots A and E**
- ☐ **Swapped: the left hand plays the famous line an octave lower**

5 MINUTES AT HOME

1. Listen to the piece once
2. Line 1, the famous bit, three times
3. Both hands, slowly
4. The roots from the names, with the band

☐ M ☐ T ☐ W ☐ T ☐ F ☐ S ☐ S

☐ **Played Ghost Walk** ☐ **Played Swing Song**